Lesson plan · for the teacher

Incident drills: practise before it happens

Cyber security · Level 4 · Lesson 3

Time
30 min

Materials
Four role cards: incident lead, communications lead, technical help, record keeper; The scenario's three updates, each on its own sheet; A sheet and pen for the record keeper

Learning goals

- Run a 30-minute tabletop drill with colleagues.
- Give each person a role and practise it.
- Turn what the drill reveals into changes.

Activity: Tabletop drill: the page taken over

1. Set-up (3 min): Hand out four role cards: incident lead, communications lead, technical help, record keeper. Everyone else plays staff. Say clearly: we are testing the plan, not people.
2. Update 1 (7 min): Read: "7 am. A parent calls: the school page is selling cheap laptops." Ask: who do we tell first, and what do we do in the first hour? The record keeper writes down the time and each decision.
3. Update 2 (7 min): Read: "8 am. Two parents say they paid a 'fee discount' to a new number. Nobody can find the page's password." Ask: what message does the communications lead send, and where? Who tries to recover the page, and how?
4. Update 3 (6 min): Read: "10 am. A local journalist calls. The school internet is down." Ask: who speaks to the journalist, and where are the key phone numbers on paper?
5. Debrief (7 min): Each person names one thing that worked and one that didn't. Agree on three lessons, and for each one a change, an owner and a date.

Prepare four role cards, the three updates on separate sheets, and a sheet for the record keeper. Ask the head teacher to open the drill and say that nobody is being tested.

Discussion

- Where is the recovery email for our page, and who can reach it?
- If the internet were down, where would we find the key phone numbers?
- What should parents hear from us in the first hour?

Exit ticket

- One weak step the drill found, and the change I will make.

Try it at school tomorrow
Ask your head teacher for 30 minutes of the next staff meeting. Bring one scenario on paper, told in three updates, and four role cards: incident lead, communications lead, technical help and record keeper.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **In the drill story, a teacher clicked a fake link first. How should the drill treat that?**

- ◯ As a weak step to fix: what would help someone report it fast?
- ◯ Leave it out of the story, so nobody is upset
- ◯ Find who would be to blame, so everyone learns

2 **Match each drill role to its job.**

Incident lead	• • • •	Recovers accounts and unplugs infected devices
Communications lead	• • • •	Writes down times, decisions and evidence
Technical help	• • • •	Decides what happens next and keeps time
Record keeper	• • • •	The only voice to parents

3 **Which of these should a drill test? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ A paper list of key numbers for when the internet is down
- ☐ Where the latest backup is, and whether it restores
- ☐ Who should be punished for the incident
- ☐ Whether anyone can find the page's recovery email
- ☐ Each teacher's score on a scam quiz, reported to the head teacher

4 **A tabletop drill needs no computers: a staffroom table, paper and the four roles are enough.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

5 **Put the steps of a drill in order.**

- ☐ At the start of the meeting, give out the four roles
- ☐ Turn each lesson into a change with an owner
- ☐ Write down three lessons
- ☐ Before the meeting, write a realistic scenario in three updates
- ☐ Read the three updates; the team decides after each

✎ **On a bad day at your school, which would break first: the contact list, the backups, the page's admins, or who speaks to parents? Why?**

Check your answers

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1 **As a weak step to fix: what would help someone report it fast?**

Anyone can click a good fake. What matters is how fast it is reported.

2 **Incident lead — Decides what happens next and keeps time**
Communications lead — The only voice to parents
Technical help — Recovers accounts and unplugs infected devices
Record keeper — Writes down times, decisions and evidence

Clear roles stop two things that make incidents worse: everyone doing the same urgent job, and nobody doing the others.

3 **Whether anyone can find the page's recovery email; Where the latest backup is, and whether it restores; A paper list of key numbers for when the internet is down**

Drills test the plan's weak links: access to recovery details, backups that really restore, and a way to call people when systems are down.

4 **True**

A tabletop drill is talk, paper and decisions.

5 **Top to bottom: 2, 5, 4, 1, 3**

The story is prepared before anyone arrives, and the roles are given out before the first update, so the updates test real decisions.